RetailzPOS / Moolah Points — Daily Trending Topics Brief

October 20, 2026

Trending now — 3 topics with a genuine brand angle

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
1	**NACS Media published a feature Oct 7, 2026 on "a smarter approach to age verification,"** interviewing We Card's president and TruAge's CEO. The piece notes shoppers are increasingly used to having their ID scanned but want clarity on how that data is handled — and that We Card developed in-store signage specifically to set consistent customer expectations around ID scanning. An industry-trade-group discussion of transparency + technology together, not a new state law.	Convenience.org / NACS — A Smarter Approach to Age Verification	**LinkedIn/Instagram, ID Check trust-angle post.** "The industry's own trade group just put out a piece making the case that age verification isn't only about the scan — it's about customers understanding what happens with their ID data, with clear signage that sets expectations before they even reach the register. That's exactly the kind of thing a consistent, built-in system handles better than a rule everyone's expected to remember." No pricing claim, no overconsumption/ underage framing — frames ID Check as a transparency and consistency tool.

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2	**Yahoo DSP's 2026 Holiday Shopping Study (published Oct 13, 2026)** found the average planned holiday budget jumped to $849, up from $788 in 2025, and 24% of shoppers said they started holiday shopping in summer — nearly double the 13% who said so in 2025. 90% of consumers expect to spend the same or more than last year.	RetailTouchPoints — Holiday Shoppers Started Earlier, Planning to Spend More: Yahoo DSP; Retail Customer Experience — Holiday Shoppers Starting Earlier, Budgets Climb to $849	**LinkedIn/Instagram, stock-now operations post.** "New holiday survey: planned spending is up to $849 per shopper this year, and a quarter of shoppers say they already started buying back in summer. The holiday rush isn't waiting for Black Friday anymore — worth checking whether your shelves, staffing, and loyalty program are ready now, not just the week before Thanksgiving." No pricing claim — a stocking/readiness prompt grounded in a real, dated survey, distinct from the Oct 17 loyalty-redemption brief (that one was about using points to cover holiday spend; this is about overall timing/budget shift).

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3	**Forrester's review of Amazon's Oct 6–7, 2026 Prime Big Deal Days** found retailers increasingly skipping sitewide discounts in favor of member-only loyalty incentives — bonus points, VIP pricing, exclusive offers — specifically to acquire members and drive repeat engagement, not just move inventory. Sitewide discounts among the 116 brands tracked fell from 14 to 7 year over year.	Forrester — Prime Big Deal Days 2026: Retailers Pull Forward Holiday Shopping	**LinkedIn, Moolah Points strategy post.** "Big retailers are quietly shifting their playbook — fewer storewide discounts, more loyalty-only perks, because it builds repeat customers instead of just moving product once. That's the same logic behind a points program at the register: it's not a discount, it's a reason for someone to come back. Worth a look if Moolah Points isn't getting pushed at checkout as hard as it could be." No pricing/ discount amount named — frames loyalty-point incentives as a retention strategy, distinct from the redemption-focused Blackhawk angle already covered Oct 17.

Skipped, no genuine angle today: World Series matchup — confirmed still unresolved as of today, with the NLCS (Dodgers/Brewers) and ALCS (Guardians/Rays) both still underway; holding per standing plan until the Series itself starts Oct 23. West Virginia's Vape Safety Act — real but its effective dates (licensing, enforcement, further 2027 phases) are all months old, not a fresh this-week story. UK ACS Crime Report findings on convenience-store theft — UK-specific and dated March/July 2026, stale. Fiserv Clover/First Data pricing increase — only sourced to a July 2026 blog post, not fresh or well-verified enough to use. TikTok/Instagram trending sounds and formats — nothing specifically dated to this week surfaced; existing results were either generic, undated, or weeks old. Diwali 2026 business news — no news dated this week found.

Compliance check: none of the three ideas imply pricing, encourage overconsumption, or use underage-adjacent framing — #1 frames ID verification as a transparency/

consistency tool, not an accusation; #2 is a stocking/readiness prompt tied to a real consumer-spending survey with no product claim; #3 frames loyalty points as a retention strategy, naming no discount amount or offer.